

Yusuf Pisan

- **Email:** pisan@uw.edu
- [Homepage](#) || [Research Group](#) || [All Course Evaluations](#) || [RateMyProfessors](#)
- **Office hours:** Monday 4:00-5:00pm, Thursday 2:00-3:00pm at UW1-260Q. Signup via [Canvas Calendar](#)
- **Class Discord:** <https://discord.gg/5mEm92e>
- You can submit [anonymous feedback](#) for this class anytime during the quarter

Course Title *Games for Good*

Quarter & Year *AUTUMN 2024*

Course Number & SLN *BCORE 104 H, SLN 11005
BCORE 110 E, SLN 11047*

Credits 5 credits

Area(s) of Inquiry A&H and NSc

Time & Location MW 5:45pm-7:45pm in UW2-040

Instructor: Professor Yusuf Pisan (he/him/his)

Email: pisan@uw.edu

Phone: FYPP Office: 425-352-3427

Office Hours Monday 4:00-5:00pm, Thursday 2:00-3:00pm at UW1-260Q. Sign up via Canvas Calendar

Communication Preference Use our class Discord channel for general queries, email for private matters. Do not use Canvas messaging. I will respond to messages within 48 hours, except on weekends.

First Year & Pre-Major Program Syllabus

In an effort to ensure an equal experience and reliable expectations across First Year and Pre-Major (FYPP) courses, all uniform FYPP policies are collected in this shared, digital "[FYPP eSyllabus](#)," which includes:

1. **Learning Goals** (Undergraduate, FYPP, and Discovery Core),

1. **FYPP & UWB Policies** (on Incompletes, Academic Integrity, Classroom Conduct, Respect for Diversity, Access & Accommodation, Religious Accommodation, Navigate Alerts, Inclement Weather, COVID-19, and Sex and Gender-based Violence and Harassment), and

1. **Student Support Services** (Veterans Services, Gender Neutral Bathrooms, Reflection Rooms, Parenting Resources, Campus Library, Career Services, Counseling Center, DACA and Undocumented Student Resources, Health and Wellness Resources Center, Academic Learning Commons, SafeCampus, Victim Advocacy & Support, The CARE Team, Diversity Center, and the Husky Pantry).

You should consider all information, learning goals, policies and guidelines from the linked “FYPP Syllabus” as a part of and included in this “Course Syllabus.” For course-specific information and policies, please refer to the Course Syllabus below.

Course Description

Games are simulations. Games are narratives. Games are puzzles. Games are advertisements. Games are commentary on social issues. Games are all those and more. Games are a form of rhetoric, a chance for the game designer to present to the player their world view. We will explore how games tackle social issues, everything from climate change to politics to education to cancer. You will play games, dissect their meaning and build your own games. Together, we will explore computational thinking and storytelling through the lens of game design.

Course Learning Objectives

At the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Identify elements of games and analyze dynamic game systems
2. Understand the hidden messages in games and how games shape players
3. Create an original game and test it

Grading Criteria

20% In-class activities & brief outside activities

40% Reflection papers (10% + 15% + 15%)

40% Group project

A scale of 90s (3.5■4.0), 80s (2.5■3.4), 70s (1.5■2.4), 60s (0.5■1.4) is a rough guide. A student who achieves 75% will receive a minimum of 2.0, 85% will receive a minimum of 3.0 and 95% and above will receive a 4.0 grade. Scores in between will be interpolated.

Schedule of Course Meetings & Major Assignments

Brief topic list included below. Refer to Canvas for weekly activities and readings.

Schedule is subject to change.

Week	Dates	Description
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1	9/25	Introduction. What is a game? What is good?
2	9/30~10/2	Game elements. Arcade games at the Library
3	10/7~10/9	Games and learning. Game analysis
4	10/14~10/16	What is fun? What games teach us
5	10/21~10/23	Game prototype challenge - Testing
6	10/28~10/30	Working in groups - rules structures
7	11/4~11/6	Game prototype challenge - Testing
8	11/11~11/13	Game pitches
9	11/18~11/20	Working on board game
10	11/25~11/27	TBD
11	12/2~12/4	Testing prototypes. Final game day

Required Texts & Resources

No required textbook. Articles and videos will be available on Canvas.

Late Work Policy

Other than the final group project, you can re-submit your reflection papers to be regraded within two weeks of the original deadline. If you do submit for regrading, the maximum additional points you can get are 50% of the points that you initially lost. For example, if you initially got 6/10 and you resubmit, your maximum possible grade is 8/10.

If you do not submit your initial work on-time, your initial grade will be 0/10, so even with resubmission, you can only get to 5/10. Make sure you submit your assignments on time.

There is no resubmission of the final group project.

Participation Policy

Since positive participation is vital for a successful experience, please arrive on time for each class. Late arrivals interrupt our in-progress activities and discussions. If you must miss a class session, let me know as soon as possible. "Positive participation" is evaluated through a combination of your contributions, attitude, preparedness, focus, behavior, and effort. There will be in-class graded activities (typically complete/incomplete)

Content Warnings Policy

Some of the material that we'll be covering may be triggering to folks who have experienced trauma (arising from violent or sexual assault, domestic abuse, racism, suicide, military combat, and more). In an effort to create an accessible learning space, I will do my best to tell you all in advance on the course schedule and prior to class sessions when a reading, film, lecture discusses potentially distressing topics. I also encourage you to practice self-care before, during and after these materials have been presented. If you find that you are struggling to process the material we cover, please let me know as soon as you feel able and consider reaching out to our Counseling Center or Victim Advocate for additional support.